

KMVTECH EDUCATION**CEL1 · Module 7****Biodiversity and ecosystems**

Lesson: Wildlife, forests, wetlands

Student Lesson Notes

Study with the online lessons. Prefer primary sources (Constitution, statutes, treaties, cases). © KMVTECH Education · September 2026.

1. CORE IDEA

Biodiversity law protects species, habitats and ecosystems. Key tools include protected areas, species listing (endangered, invasive), wildlife trade controls (CITES-aligned), forest and wetland conservation regimes, and access and benefit-sharing for genetic resources.

Uganda's wildlife, forestry and wetland laws, together with the National Environment Act and international commitments (CBD, CITES), form the core. Community-based and participatory approaches are increasingly important.

Threats include habitat loss, poaching, invasive species, pollution and climate change. Legal responses combine prohibition, sustainable-use licensing, restoration duties and economic incentives.

- Wetlands and forests also provide critical ecosystem services (water regulation, carbon, livelihoods) that justify strict protection.

2. DETAILED RULES AND APPLICATION

Example: conversion of a protected wetland or unlicensed wildlife trade engages both domestic criminal provisions and, potentially, international reporting and cooperation duties.

Identify the species or ecosystem, its legal status (protected area, listed species, regulated use), and the specific prohibition or permit requirement.

3. UGANDA / PRACTICE, METHOD AND TRAPS

Uganda's protected-area network and species laws are relatively strong on paper; pressure from agriculture, infrastructure and illegal trade tests enforcement. Benefit-sharing and community rights are live policy issues.

Exam trap: treating all natural resources as freely alienable private property without checking public-trust, protected-area or species rules.

Method: classify the resource (species / habitat / ecosystem service) → locate protective status and governing statute → check permit or prohibition → assess restoration or compensation duties → consider community and international dimensions.

Prepares for the final liability and public-interest module.

SELF-TEST QUESTIONS

Attempt these before the platform practice quiz.

1. Name three legal tools for biodiversity protection.
2. What does CITES regulate?
3. Why are wetlands specially protected?
4. What is access and benefit-sharing?
5. Name two major threats to biodiversity in Uganda.
6. Why does legal status of the area or species matter?

Exam tip: Status first; then prohibition, permit or restoration.

CHECKLIST BEFORE YOU LEAVE THIS LESSON

- I can state the main instrument(s) or Cap number.
- I can explain the core rule in my own words.
- I can apply the rule to a short Uganda / regional fact pattern.
- I know the common exam trap for this topic.
- I know how this lesson links to the next module.

Next step: Complete the online practice quiz for this lesson, then continue on the platform.